

2026

English — Grade 6

Specimen Paper 3 of 4

Time allowed: 1 hour 45 minutes

Total marks: 100

Index Number:

Name: _____

Class:

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. This paper contains **9 questions**.
2. Write your Index Number in the space provided above.
3. Answer **all** questions.
4. Write your answers clearly in the spaces provided.
5. You may not use red, green or black ink.

[illegible]

Question 1 — Sentence Matching (5 marks)

Match each sentence on the left with the most suitable sentence on the right. An example is given. There is **one extra sentence** on the right that you will not use.

Example: The battery is fully charged. •

• *We can use the device for much longer.*

(i) The solar panel is facing the sun directly. •

• **A.** It will produce more electricity.

(ii) The robot ran out of power. •

• **B.** It stopped moving suddenly.

(iii) The scientist wore protective goggles. •

• **C.** She was doing a dangerous experiment.

(iv) The computer screen went blank suddenly. •

• **D.** The power had been cut off.

(v) The pupil forgot to save her document. •

• **E.** She lost everything she had typed.

• **F.** The phone rang during the lesson.

Write the correct letter in each box:

(i) (ii) (iii) (iv) (v)

Question 2 — Grammar (10 marks)

Circle the letter which shows the correct answer.

Example: Priya her project last night.

A finish

(B) finished

C is finishing

D finishes

1. Scientists work when they carry out experiments.

A careless

B carefully

C caring

D care

2. The solar panel on the school roof since January.

A was

B has been

C is being

D were

3. There is electricity left in the battery. We must charge it now.

A many

B few

Question 3B — Vocabulary (5 marks)

Circle the letter which shows the correct word to complete each sentence.

1. The science teacher asked the class to the results of their experiment.

A ignore

B record

C forget

D lose

2. The engineers were when the new bridge held up perfectly in the storm.

A bored

B frightened

C relieved

D careless

3. My brother likes to gadgets and electronic devices at home.

A destroy

B ignore

C build

D forget

4. She spoke very and clearly so that all the judges could follow her explanation.

A quietly

B sadly

C angrily

D confidently

5. The at the science centre showed the pupils how a telescope works.

A mechanic

B demonstrator

C plumber

D tailor

Question 4A — Reading Comprehension: Informational Text (10 marks)

Read the text below, then complete the sentences that follow.

Solar Energy in Mauritius

Solar energy is energy produced from sunlight. It is one of the cleanest and most plentiful sources of power available on Earth. Solar panels, also known as photovoltaic cells, are flat devices that capture sunlight and convert it into electricity. They are made from a special material called silicon, which absorbs light and releases electrons to create an electric current.

In Mauritius, the use of solar energy has grown rapidly in recent years. Many homes, schools and businesses have installed solar panels on their rooftops. The government has set a target to generate thirty-five percent of the country's electricity from renewable sources by 2025. Solar farms — large areas covered with rows of solar panels — have also been built in several parts of the island.

Solar energy has many advantages. It is free and renewable, meaning it will never run out while the sun shines. It produces no harmful gases, unlike coal or oil. Once panels are installed, running costs are very low. In remote areas of Mauritius, solar panels provide electricity to communities that are not connected to the main power grid.

However, there are some challenges. Solar panels can be expensive to buy and install. They only produce electricity during daylight hours, and cloudy weather reduces their efficiency. Scientists are working to develop better battery systems to store solar energy for use at night or during bad weather. Solar energy represents an important part of Mauritius's clean energy future.

Original passage

Based on the text, complete the following.

Example: This text is about: solar energy in Mauritius

1. Another name for solar panels: _____
2. Material solar panels are made from: _____
3. Government target for renewable energy by 2025: _____
4. What solar farms are: _____

5. One advantage of solar energy (other than being free): _____
6. How solar energy helps remote communities: _____
7. One challenge of solar panels: _____
8. When solar panels do not produce electricity: _____
9. What scientists are developing to store solar energy: _____
10. What solar energy represents for Mauritius's future: _____

Question 4B — Reading Comprehension: Narrative (15 marks)

Priya's Invention

Priya was a twelve-year-old girl who had always been fascinated by science. When her teacher announced the annual school science fair, Priya immediately had an idea: she would build a small solar-powered fan.

She spent two weeks working on her project. She researched solar panels and bought a small kit from a local shop. Every evening after school, she sat at the kitchen table, carefully connecting wires and testing the circuit. Her younger brother Jai sat beside her, handing her tools and asking endless questions.

"Why does it need a battery?" Jai asked one evening.

"Because when there is no sun, the battery stores the energy so the fan can still work," Priya explained patiently.

On the day of the science fair, Priya set up her model on the table. When the judges approached, she placed the solar panel under the classroom light and switched on the fan. It whirred into life immediately. The judges smiled and made careful notes on their clipboards.

"Can you explain how it works?" asked one judge.

Priya spoke clearly and confidently. She explained how light hit the solar panel, created electricity and powered the motor in the fan. The judges were visibly impressed.

At the award ceremony that afternoon, Priya was called to the stage to receive the first-prize trophy. The hall erupted in applause. Her parents hugged her tightly. Jai pulled her sleeve and whispered, "I knew you would win." Priya laughed and hugged him back. It had been the best day of her life.

Original passage

1. Indicate whether each statement is True or False. Tick (✓) the correct box.

[3]

Statement	True	False
(i) Priya decided to build a solar-powered lamp.	☐	☐

Statement	True	False
(ii) Jai helped Priya by handing her tools.	☐	☐
(iii) Priya received the second-prize trophy.	☐	☐

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

2. What gave Priya the idea for her project? [1]

- A Her parents suggested it B Her teacher announced a science fair
C She saw one in a shop D Jai asked about solar panels

3. In paragraph 5, "whirred" suggests the fan ... [1]

- A stopped working B made a humming sound as it spun
C broke down D was too slow

4. Why did Priya include a battery in her solar fan? [1]

- A To make it look nicer B To power the light
C To store energy for when there is no sun D To save money

5. Which word BEST describes Priya? [1]

- A disorganised B careless
C determined D impatient

Answer the following questions based on the text.

6. Why was Priya sitting at the kitchen table every evening after school? [1]

7. How did Priya feel when explaining her project to the judges? Give evidence from the text. [2]

8. In your own words, explain why Priya put a battery in her solar fan. [2]

9. How do you know that Jai was proud of his sister? Give evidence from the text.

[2]

10. How did the audience react when Priya received her prize?

[1]

Question 5 — Sentence Writing (10 marks)

(i) Removing the extra word:

[1]

The scientist has already made a great a discovery this year.

(ii) Adding the required capital letter and full stop:

[1]

priya built a solar-powered fan for the school science fair

(iii) Putting the adverb 'carefully' in the right place:

[1]

She connected the wires to the battery.

(iv) Putting the words in order to make a sentence:

[1]

solar – panel – the – collected – energy – sun

(v) Transforming into its NEGATIVE form:

[2]

The judges were pleased with Priya's project.

(vi) Transforming into its INTERROGATIVE form:

[2]

Jai helped Priya build the solar fan.

(vii) Write ONE sentence using these words:
sunlight – energy – produce

[2]

Question 6A — Cloze Test: Word Bank (5 marks)

Complete the text by choosing the correct word from the word bank. The first one has been done for you. There is **one extra word** you will not use.

Word Bank: carefully • amazing • connected • inside • quickly • never • always

Scientists work carefully when building new machines. A robot is an
_____ device that can perform tasks on its own. Its different parts are
_____ by wires and circuits. When given a command, it
_____ carries it out. The power source is stored _____
the robot's body. Engineers _____ stop looking for ways to improve
their designs.

Question 6B — Cloze Test: Your Own Words (5 marks)

Complete the text by writing **one suitable word** in each blank space.

Priya _____ the solar fan on and watched the blades begin to
_____. She was very _____ that it was working perfectly.
Her teacher _____ over to look at it. "This is wonderful work!" she said.
Priya _____ and thanked her politely.

Question 7A — Error Correction (5 marks)

Correct the underlined mistakes. Write the correct word in the bracket. The first one has been done for you.

Last Tuesday, our class maked (**made**) a visit to the science museum in Port Louis.

We seed () many interesting machines and inventions. A guide
telled () us about electricity and how it is () first
discovered. Our teacher gived () us a worksheet to fill in while we
explored the museum.

Question 7B — Word Forms (5 marks)

Fill in each blank using the correct form of the word given in CAPITALS.

Solar energy is a _____ (REMARK) source of clean power. Scientists
have been _____ (STUDY) it for many years. Their _____
(DISCOVER) have helped make solar panels more efficient. Building a solar farm is
an _____ (EXPENSE) task, but the results are truly _____
(WORTH).

Question 8A — Picture Story (6 marks)

Write **one sentence** for each picture to make a short story. Use the words given.

[Picture 1: A child reads a book about robots and inventions at a desk, looking very interested]

one evening – book

[Picture 2: The child sits at a table building a small robot from cardboard, wire and batteries]

the next day – started

[Picture 3: The completed robot moves across the table; the child's parents watch and clap proudly]

at last – worked

Question 8B — Sentence Linking (4 marks)

Use the word in brackets to link the two sentences. Make any necessary changes.

Example: Zara loves science. She joins the robotics club. (so) → Zara loves science, so she joins the robotics club.

1. Priya won first prize. She worked very hard on her project. (**because**)

[1]

2. Professor Rajan is a famous scientist. He visits our school every year. (**who**)

[1]

3. The judge saw the solar fan working. She was very impressed. (**when**)

[1]

4. Jai gave Priya the tools. He cheered her on the whole time. (**and**)

[1]

Question 9 — Writing Task (10 marks)

Imagine you could invent any machine or gadget you wished.

Write a composition of about **120 words** to describe your invention.

The following may help you:

- What is your invention called?
- What does it do?
- How does it work?
- Why would it be useful to people?

Mark Scheme — Specimen Paper 3

These suggested answers are a guide only. Accept any reasonable answer demonstrating clear understanding. For open writing tasks, apply holistic judgement.

Question 1 — Sentence Matching (5 marks)

Item	Answer
(i)	A — It will produce more electricity.
(ii)	B — It stopped moving suddenly.
(iii)	C — She was doing a dangerous experiment.
(iv)	D — The power had been cut off.
(v)	E — She lost everything she had typed.
Extra	F — The phone rang during the lesson.

Question 2 — Grammar MCQ (10 marks)

Q	Answer	Q	Answer
1	B — carefully	6	C — was helping
2	B — has been	7	C — themselves
3	C — little	8	C — shown
4	C — the best	9	B — whose
5	C — on	10	C — because

Question 3A — Word Definitions (5 marks)

Item	Answer
(i)	Solar (energy)
(ii)	Robot
(iii)	Scientist
(iv)	Battery
(v)	Invention

Question 3B — Vocabulary MCQ (5 marks)

Q	Answer
1	B — record
2	C — relieved
3	C — build
4	D — confidently

Q	Answer
5	B — demonstrator

Question 4A — Informational Text (10 marks)

Q	Answer
1	Photovoltaic cells
2	Silicon
3	Thirty-five percent from renewable sources by 2025
4	Large areas covered with rows of solar panels
5	It produces no harmful gases / running costs are very low (either)
6	They provide electricity to communities not connected to the main grid
7	Expensive to buy and install / reduced efficiency on cloudy days (either)
8	At night / during cloudy weather / outside daylight hours
9	Better battery systems
10	An important part of Mauritius's clean energy future

Question 4B — Narrative Comprehension (15 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks
1(i)	False (it was a solar-powered fan)	1
1(ii)	True	1
1(iii)	False (she received the first-prize trophy)	1
2	B — Her teacher announced a science fair	1
3	B — made a humming sound as it spun	1
4	C — To store energy for when there is no sun	1
5	C — determined	1
6	She was working on her solar-powered fan project / connecting wires and testing the circuit	1
7	She felt confident — evidence: "spoke clearly and confidently" (1 feeling + 1 evidence)	2
8	The battery stores energy from the sun so the fan can continue working even when there is no sunlight (1 mark each for storing + continued function)	2
9	He whispered "I knew you would win" to her at the ceremony (1 mark evidence + 1 mark inference)	2
10	The hall erupted in applause	1

Question 5 — Sentence Writing (10 marks)

Item	Acceptable Answer	Marks
(i)	The scientist has already made a great discovery this year. (remove "a")	1

Item	Acceptable Answer	Marks
(ii)	Priya built a solar-powered fan for the school science fair.	1
(iii)	She carefully connected the wires to the battery.	1
(iv)	The solar panel collected energy from the sun.	1
(v)	The judges were not pleased with Priya's project.	2
(vi)	Did Jai help Priya build the solar fan?	2
(vii)	Any correct sentence, e.g. "Solar panels use sunlight to produce electricity."	2

Question 6A — Cloze: Word Bank (5 marks)

Blank	Answer
1 (done)	carefully
2	amazing
3	connected
4	quickly
5	inside
6	never
Extra (unused)	always

Question 6B — Cloze: Own Words (5 marks)

Blank	Acceptable Answers
1	switched / turned / put
2	spin / turn / rotate / move
3	pleased / happy / excited / thrilled
4	came / walked / moved
5	smiled / laughed / bowed / nodded

Question 7A — Error Correction (5 marks)

Error	Correction
maked (done)	made
seed	saw
telled	told
is	was
gived	gave

Question 7B — Word Forms (5 marks)

Root Word	Correct Form
REMARK	remarkable

Root Word	Correct Form
STUDY	studying
DISCOVER	discoveries
EXPENSE	expensive
WORTH	worthwhile

Question 8A — Picture Story (6 marks)

Picture	Sample Answer	Marks
1	One evening, I read a fascinating book about robots and inventions.	2
2	The next day, I started building my own small robot from cardboard and wire.	2
3	At last, my robot worked and my parents clapped with pride.	2

Question 8B — Sentence Linking (4 marks)

Q	Acceptable Answer
1	Priya won first prize because she worked very hard on her project.
2	Professor Rajan, who is a famous scientist, visits our school every year.
3	When the judge saw the solar fan working, she was very impressed.
4	Jai gave Priya the tools and cheered her on the whole time.

Question 9 — Writing Task (10 marks)

Criterion	Marks
Content: describes the invention clearly using the bullet-point guide	up to 4
Language: clear vocabulary, accurate grammar, correct spelling	up to 4
Organisation: logical sequence, clear structure	up to 2

Sample answer: My invention is called the HydroBot. It is a small waterproof robot that can clean the bottoms of rivers and lagoons. It works by swimming along the riverbed with tiny arms that pick up litter, plastic bags and waste. The rubbish is stored in a container inside the robot. When the container is full, the robot rises to the surface and a light flashes to let the operator know. The HydroBot runs on solar energy, so it does not need batteries or petrol. I think it would be extremely useful in Mauritius because our lagoons are so important for tourism and marine life. With this robot, we could keep our waters clean without putting any person in danger.